



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Randhir Singh becomes first Indian to be elected as OCA president



Veteran sports administrator Randhir Singh became the first Indian to be elected as the president of the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) during the 44th General Assembly of the continental body.

A five-time Olympic shooter, Randhir was the lone eligible candidate for the OCA president's post. His tenure will run from 2024 till 2028, and his election was unanimous.

The 77-year-old Randhir has been the OCA acting president since 2021, filling in for Kuwait's Sheikh Ahmad Al-Fahad Al-Sabah, who was handed a 15-year ban from sports administration in May this year over ethics breaches.

Randhir, who held different administrative posts in Indian and Asian sports bodies, was officially named OCA president in the presence of Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya and top sports leaders from all 45 countries of Asia.

He hails from Patiala in Punjab and belongs to a family of sportspersons.

Randhir was also a member of the IOC between 2001 and 2014, after which he continued as the honorary member of the global sports body.

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1 Wrestler Bajrang Punia has approached the Delhi High Court, seeking to overturn the provisional suspension imposed on him by the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) for refusing to provide a urine sample during the National selection trials in Sonipat on March 10. NADA had suspended him on April 23 for his refusal to comply with the dope test at the selection trials. The global wrestling body, UWW, had also imposed a suspension on him. Bajrang had previously challenged this provisional suspension, leading to the NADA Anti-Disciplinary Doping Panel (ADDP) revoking it on May 31, pending NADA's issuance of a formal notice of charge. In response, NADA served Bajrang with the notice in June.

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2 The National Pickleball Championship, featuring all age groups of boys and girls, apart from men, women and veterans, will be hosted at the Sewa Sadhana Kendra, Patti Kalyana, Samalkha, Panipat, from October 4 to 6. The affiliated units of the All India Pickleball Association (AIPA) will be eligible to compete. The last date for sending entries by the state units will be September 29. All the teams will be provided accommodation from October 4 to 7. The host will also serve all the meals for the players, coaches and officials at the venue.

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